

# Chapter-5

## VI Editor (VISUAL EDITOR)

The VI editor is the most popular and classic text editor in the Linux family. Vi or the Visual Editor is the default text editor that comes with most Linux systems.

It is a Terminal-based text editor that users need to learn, essentially when more user-friendly text editors are not available on the system.

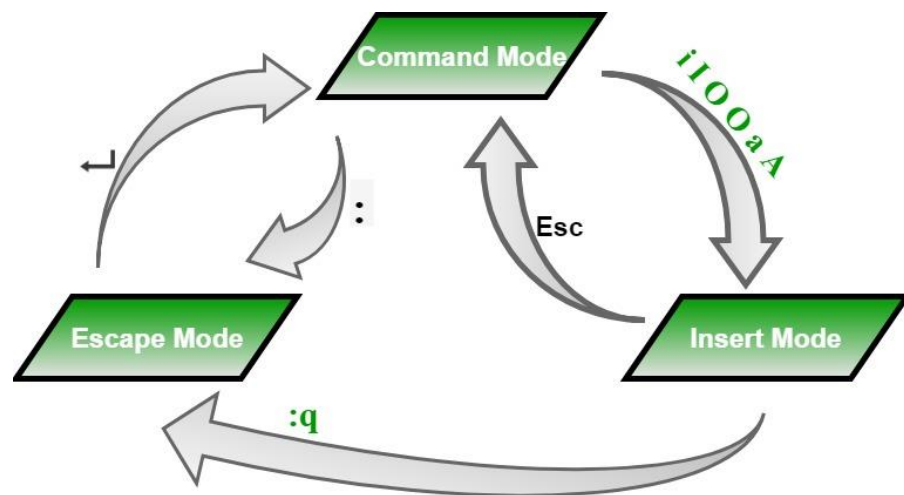
Some other reasons to use Vi include: VI is available on almost all operating systems.

- The vi editor is the most popular and commonly used Unix text editor
- It is usually available in all Linux Distributions.
- It works in two modes, Command and Insert
- Command mode takes the user commands, and the Insert mode is for editing text
- You should know the commands to work on your file easily
- Learning to use this editor can benefit you in creating scripts and editing files.

Below, are some reasons which make it a widely used editor –

- 1) It is available in almost all Linux Distributions
- 2) It works the same across different platforms and Distributions
- 3) It is user-friendly. Hence, millions of Linux users love it and use it for their editing needs

To work on VI editor, you need to understand **its operation modes**. They can be divided into two main parts



```
guru99@VirtualBox:~$ cat samplefile
Hello World!
guru99@VirtualBox:~$
```

## VI Editing commands

- i - Insert at cursor (goes into insert mode)
- a - Write after cursor (goes into insert mode)
- A - Write at the end of line (goes into insert mode)
- ESC - Terminate insert mode
- u - Undo last change
- U - Undo all changes to the entire line
- o - Open a new line (goes into insert mode)
- dd - Delete line
- 3dd - Delete 3 lines.
- D - Delete contents of line after the cursor
- C - Delete contents of a line after the cursor and insert new text. Press ESC key to end insertion.
- dw - Delete word
- 4dw - Delete 4 words
- cw - Change word
- x - Delete character at the cursor
- r - Replace character
- R - Overwrite characters from cursor onward
- s - Substitute one character under cursor continue to insert
- S - Substitute entire line and begin to insert at the beginning of the line
- ~ - Change case of individual character

## Moving within a file

- k - Move cursor up
- j - Move cursor down
- h - Move cursor left
- l - Move cursor right

You need to be in the command mode to move within a file. The default keys for navigation are mentioned below else; You can **also use the arrow keys on the keyboard.**

## Saving and Closing the file

- Shift+zz - Save the file and quit
- :w - Save the file but keep it open
- :q - Quit without saving
- :wq - Save the file and quit

You should be in the **command mode to exit the editor and save changes** to the file.

# Commands to use vi editor

1.To view number of lines

```
[root@localhost ~]# vi file1.txt
```

ENTER “ :se nu ”

```
1 This is File1
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
:se nu                      6,0-1      All
```

1.To go to particular line number

```
1 This is File1
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
:3                          3,1      All
```

2.To go to end of line

PRESS ‘ SHIFT + G ’

```
1 This is File1
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
6,0-1      All
```

3.To go to first line

PRESS ‘ SHIFT + H ’

```
1 This is File1
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
1,1 All
```

4.To search for particular word in file

ENTER ‘ / (word) ’

```
1 This is File1
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
/Editor
```

5.To delete a single line

Take cursor to that particular line and PRESS ‘dd’ for 2 times.

6.To undo the deleted file or line

PRESS ‘ ALT + U ’

7.To delete a multiple files

PRESS 5(no. of line) times ‘dd’

8.To copy a single file

PRESS ‘yy’

9.To paste a line

PRESS ‘p’

10. To copy multiple lines of a file

PRESS 3(no. of lines) ‘yy’

11.To cut paste multiple lines of files

PRESS 4(no. of lines) ‘cc’

PRESS ‘esc’ ‘p’

12.To copy a single word

PRESS ‘yw’

13.To cut a single word

PRESS ‘cw’

14.To replace a word

ENTER “ :%s/(old name)/(new name)/g ”

```
1 This is File1
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
:%s/File1/File2/g
```

```
1 This is File2
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
:%s/File1/File2/g      1,1      All
```

### 15. To Save the File

Enter :- :wq! – It will Save the file

```
1 This is File2
2 In this Session
3 We will check
4 How Vi Editor Works
5 Lets Go
6
~
~
:wq!
```

### 16. To change hostname

ENTER “ hostnamectl hostname (new-name)

‘exec bash’ – to reload bash file

```
[root@localhost ~]# hostname
localhost.localdomain
[root@localhost ~]# hostnamectl hostname server1.testdomain
[root@localhost ~]# exec bash
[root@server1 ~]# hostname
server1.testdomain
[root@server1 ~]#
```